The Mountainside

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Negotiation Team Reaches Agreement in Principle with Coolfont Development Corporation

By Jackson Bain, Arleigh Greenblatt, and Don Green

The CMA negotiating team completed discussions with Sam and Martha Ashelman of Coolfont Development Corporation with the drafting of an agreement in principle that would provide a significant financial contribution to the much-needed water-sewer upgrade and other infrastructure improvements.

The agreement calls for CDC to pay our association a total of $110.000 over a 24-month period, beginning with a $25,000 payment concurrent with the signing of the final agreement, followed by two payments of $42,500 each on the anniversaries of the agreement date.

CDC will get the opportunity to develop a total of eight lots in the Salmon tract, which would become part of CMA, along with the common land associated with those lots. Acceptance of new lands requires a 2/3 approval of the membership voting at a general meeting.

The agreement would bring to a conclusion all claims and counter claims related to the 1986 CDC-CMA agreement. With final approval, CMA will terminate the formal arbitration process.

CDC must submit its plans for the expansion to the Morgan County Planning Commission for approval, and CMA will have the opportunity to review those plans prior to submission.

The Board of Directors has approved the general principles of the agreement, directed that a full agreement document be drawn up, and has called for a general membership meeting on March 11th to vote on the new land issue.

DATES TO REMEMBER:

JANUARY BOARD MEETING
10:00 a.m. January 7, 1995
Davis Memorial Library
6400 Democracy Boulevard
Bethesda, MD

FEBRUARY BOARD MEETING
10:00 a.m. February 4, 1995
Davis Memorial Library

GENERAL MEMBER MEETING
March 11, 1995
Time and Place to be announced

It is important to note that this agreement requires no common land trades, as specified by the resolution of the membership at September's annual meeting.

The new lots would be connected to CMA through a new side road running off South Mountainside road, following the current access road to the Salmon well. This 16-foot wide gravel road would not carry construction traffic.

As discussed with CDC, all construction traffic for the new lots would access the property directly from Cold Run Valley Road.

Work on the new lots would begin in the Spring of next year, pending member approval of the new common lands and the approval of the Morgan County Planning Commission.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE WATER-SEWER UPGRADE

The $110,000 payment from CDC means a substantial part of the financing for construction of a water and sewer system that meets the needs of this community will be in place.

The rest of the money could come from a variety of sources, including loans from government and private sources, and from member assessments.

The Finance Committee was directed at the December Board meeting to complete its work in developing a financing plan for the remainder of the necessary funding for the water-sewer upgrade.

But the Board also looked at other infrastructure problems that could be solved, as well. Road paving for those sections of the Mountainside Road that are severely damaged is also on the list of needed repairs, as are the tennis courts and the swimming pool. The Board will determine how those issues will be resolved during the next several meetings, and member opinions are appreciated.

Contribute to the Mountainside!
If you have articles or tips for your neighbors, call Jackson Bain:
(703)549-9592



Board members tour CMA infrastructure with Don Fox, Elmer Broxson, and DACC Chair Linda Clark.



A section of the South Mountainside Road paved with "tar and chip" which has worn down to the dirt.

BOARD MEMBERS SEE INFRASTRUCTURE PROBLEMS

CMA board members toured the mountainside prior to the regular board meeting in November, to get a first-hand view of the existing water and sewer system, and a "from-the-ground-up" lesson in building and maintaining the existing road surfaces.

Road engineer Don Kine and CMA past president Don Fox guided the tour of the South Mountainside Road for the board, explaining the differences in costs for building, then maintaining the different types of roads on the mountainside.

Then the board took to the woods for a tour of the water system, starting with the Salmon well and moving up to the Leach reservoir above the "E" section. Elmer Broxson showed the board how the system works, and pointed out specific problems that continue to arise.

Dwain Place and Elmer developed a comprehensive water-sewer installation display in the barn, complete with photographs and actual hardware and piping, which was damaged or had developed leaks and had been replaced.

The board members toured the lagoon and the wetlands area, as well, learning how that section of the sewer system processes and cleans the water coming from each home's septic system.

The tour was organized to give the Board a better understanding of how the current water and sewer system is set up and how it works, as plans are laid for correcting the recurring problems with a new system.

Several sections of paved road on the mountainside are in bad repair, and board members expressed concern that the damaged areas would get worse over the expected hard winter.

BE WATER-WISE! AN OUNCE OF PREVENTION IS WORTH THOUSANDS OF GALLONS!

by Jim Bradfield

By now, every homeowner should have received their quarterly water bill. If not received, contact me for a replacement statement.

As a means of encouraging water conservation, homeowners should look at their current water bill and review it for the effect the new water charge of $23 per 1,000 gallons would cost in equivalent water use during the next quarter.

As we advance into the winter season and freezing weather, please check your homes to ensure the house is properly winterized to avoid ruptured pipes caused by ice. Disconnect outside hoses from faucets. If your home is used infrequently during the winter, turn off the main water valve in or under the house during those periods when it is empty. Also, arrange for someone to periodically check the house and immediate area for leaks.

When you are at your home, every effort you make to save water helps YOU, as well as our community.

MOUNTAINSIDE SECRETS

The Highlawn Inn - Berkeley Springs
by Rosemary Bigelow

Last issue, Rosemary Bigelow *let us in on her favorite place for great steaks and roasted garlic. This month, she shares her fondness for a special and little-known jewel overlooking downtown Berkeley Springs - The Highlawn Inn.*

The Highlawn Inn is a charming B&B on Market Street above the CNB main branch. They have great food and if you make reservations well in advance, you can eat there even if you are not an overnight guest. It is worth the effort, and the wait!

All winter long (and occasionally in the summer), you can have Sunday brunch, if you call ahead ($10 plus tax and gratuity).

May through October, they offer Saturday night multi-course silver plate dinners with wine. Reservations as far ahead as possible are a must - the dining room only seats 20 people - but it is a great way to celebrate life's special moments ($35 plus tax and gratuity).

The Highlawn Inn also has special events during the winter. They decorate beautifully for the holidays and you can have a private party (minimum 15 people). You can have events from High Tea to a cocktail party to a full dinner party.

Special event dinners are also planned and available for booking in January and February. One of these is their "Hearts Aglow" dinner at 7:00 p.m. on Saturday, February 11 before the lighted Valentine Tree!

You should call the Inn for information and reservations.

The Highlawn Inn
(304) 258-5700

DO YOU HAVE A SECRET?
SHARE IT WITH THE REST OF US!
(WE WON'T TELL A SOUL!)
Call or write Jackson Bain

MEET YOUR NEIGHBORS!

Bassett and Elizabeth Ferguson

Katydid B-4, B-5

They met at Swarthmore, where Bassett was a senior and Elizabeth was a sophomore. Under the old trees on that venerable campus, they fell in love. They married shortly after. The year was 1936.

Bassett was a chemical engineer for some years, then he went into the design and construction of supermarkets around the U.S., Canada, and in Puerto Rico. While in San Juan, they began looking around the Caribbean for a home, finding it on the small island of Nevis.

Here, Bassett became a writer. His first was a cookbook, Cooking Caribbean, which included "small tales from a small isle". Two of his other books, The Adventures of Bobo Johnny on the Island of Nevis , and Look Back with Love, are still for sale (and can be found at Treetop House).

Elizabeth was busy, as well, establishing milk goats on the island, and experimenting to introduce legumes, to avoid expensive imported foods. They wrote a book on breeding and raising goats that was used by "Goat Clubs" they established in the island schools.

Their hobbies are reading, classical chamber music and conversation. For twenty years, they led a Great Books Group, and think it would be fun to start one at Coolfont.

They winter in the Florida Keys, returning to Katydid with the Spring robins!

The Design and Architectural Review Committee is still looking for your ideas and recommendations on changes in the DACC Guidelines. Please call Linda Clark, DACC Chair, before December 31!
(301) 588-1331

Board Meetings in January and February

Directions to the Davis Memorial Library in Bethesda, MD

The Library is located at 6400 Democracy Boulevard, halfway between the I-270 exit and Old Georgetown Road. Parking is in the rear. Board meetings are held downstairs one of the two meeting rooms.

